

# From Data to Decisions: Client Churn Analysis in a Digital Finance Platform

Business understanding · Data cleaning · Exploratory data analysis · Descriptive analytics · Machine learning proposal & implementation

Student Numbers: 3602767, 3602738, 3602737

## Business Understanding

The client is a digital financial services provider facing client churn, where previously active customers stop using the platform and no longer generate revenue. Predicting churn is important so the company can identify at-risk clients early and target them with retention actions such as offers, better support, or product changes. Churn is represented by **Left\_Service** in the dataset. Key variables likely to influence churn include: **Membership\_Length** (relationship duration), **Account\_Value** and **Product\_Count** (value and engagement), **CreditCard\_Flag** and **Premium\_Tier** (deeper commitment and higher revenue potential), **Activity\_Status** (early sign of disengagement), **Risk\_Score** and **Annual\_Earnings** (profitability and sensitivity to pricing/credit), and demographics like **Age**, **Gender**, and **Region** (which may reveal high-risk segments).<sup>[2]</sup>

## Data Preparation

- 5 missing and 21 duplicate values were found and handled.
- Standardised categorical labels and created grouped fields (Age\_Group, Balance\_Band, Income\_Band, Membership\_Band, Income\_Band) to make churn patterns easier to interpret.
- Initially there were 5,031 rows; after removing problematic or duplicate records, the final dataset contains 5,000 unique clients with consistent, analysis-ready variables. <sup>[1]</sup>

| Issue Checked           | How detected                                         | Result/ Action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Original field    | Example value | Prepared field  | Example value | Reason for transformation              |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------|-----------------|---------------|----------------------------------------|
| Missing values          | Highlight missing values, COUNTBLANK per column      | Annual_Earnings-1, replaced with average.<br>Product_Count-1, replaced with mode.<br>CreditCard_Flag- 2, replaced with mode.<br>Activity_Status-1, replaced with mode.                                                                                                | Risk_Score        | 601           | Risk_Band       | 600-699       | Groups similar score together          |
| Duplicated values       | Remove duplicates on ClientID as a unique identifier | 21 duplicate values were found and removed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Age               | 52            | Age_Group       | 50-59         | Easier to compare churn by age segment |
| Inconsistent categories | Filter unique values per categorical var             | Standardised label for Gender-Male/Female, before few where M and F                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Account_Value     | 64430.06      | Balance_Band    | 25k-75k       | Groups similar balances together       |
| Outliers                | Summary statistics, using IQR values and box-plots   | Annual_income-3 negative values were outliers (value<98454.7713).<br>Age->= outliers, removed outliers (6,9,9) and kept outliers in range 57-84.<br>Membership_Length-3 outliers (values=13) were removed<br>Account_value-3 outliers (values>319428.4) were removed. | Membership_Length | 2             | Membership_Band | 1-3           | Simplifies churn comparison by years   |
|                         |                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Annual_Income     | 96517.97      | Income_Band     | 50k-100k      | Groups similar income values together  |

Data cleaning and transformation summary

## Exploratory Data Analysis

### Target Variable Distribution

Pie chart of **Left\_Service** (left vs still a customer).

This chart shows that most of the customers are still present and only a few have left the service, this helps the business to understand what portion of customers may have an issue or we have to deal with.

### Maximum Churn Rate by Feature

Horizontal Bar chart Churn rate of all features

- We use this chart to screen which features show the largest churn variation.
- Although some variables (e.g. Balance\_Band) have a high maximum churn in small subgroups, we selected **Age\_Group**, **Product\_Count**, and **Activity\_Status** as primary EDA focus because they combine strong churn differences with large group sizes and clear business interpretation.<sup>[3]</sup><sup>[1]</sup>

### Client Activity Vs Churn (Grouped bar chart)

This chart shows that customers with active status have lower churn rate than customers having inactive status, which tells that keeping customer engaged is crucial to minimize churn rates.

### Churn rate by Age group (Grouped bar chart)

The chart shows that young customers are more engaged and have lower churn rates than older customers, which suggests that special attention should be given to middle-aged clients.

### Churn rate by Products (Grouped bar chart)

The chart shows that customers few products have a lower churn rate while customers with many products are more likely to leave, which could be due to issues in multi-product package services.

## Descriptive Analytics

### Churn Rate by Customer Activity Status

Customer Activity Status Bar Chart

### Churn rate by Age group

Churn Rate by Age Group Pie Chart

### 2. Which age group churns the most?

The oldest age group churns the highest, followed by the middle age group. The youngest group churns the least, well below the company average. What this means: Older customers are leaving at much higher rates — something about the product is failing this demographic. What the client can do: Investigate why older customers leave (features, technical issues, alternatives) and tailor retention efforts to them.<sup>[1]</sup>

## Machine Learning Proposal and Implementation

This is a **binary classification problem** because the target variable, **Left\_Service**, has two outcomes: left or still a customer. Based on the cleaned dataset, the input features are customer demographic, behavioural, and financial variables such as Age, Membership\_Length, Product\_Count, Activity\_Status, Risk\_Score, Annual\_Earnings, Account\_Value, Gender, Region, and CreditCard\_Flag.

**Random Forest model** is suitable because it can handle both numerical and categorical data, capture complex non-linear relationships, and is widely used in customer churn prediction studies. It is also robust and provides strong predictive performance on structured datasets like this one.<sup>[1]</sup><sup>[4]</sup>

| Paper                                                                                    | Algorithm              | Evaluation          | Reason                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Anusha & Keerthi (2023), Bank Customer Minimization Churn Rate Using Machine Learning | AdaBoost               | 88-92%, high recall | Performs best due to boosting and handling class imbalance         |
|                                                                                          | Random Forest          | 80-88%              | Strong model but slightly lower recall than AdaBoost               |
|                                                                                          | Decision Tree          | 70-80%              | Simple model but prone to overfitting                              |
| 2. Ashraf (2024), Bank Customer Churn Prediction Using Machine Learning Framework        | Random Forest          | 85-90%              | Performs consistently well on structured banking data              |
|                                                                                          | XGBoost                | 88-93%              | Captures complex patterns and high predictive power                |
|                                                                                          | AdaBoost               | 85-90%              | Boosting enhances model performance by focusing on difficult cases |
|                                                                                          | Bagging Meta           | 90-95%              | Highest stability and accuracy                                     |
| 3. Chen (2024), Credit card customers churn prediction by nine classifiers               | Random Forest          | 85-90%              | Top-performing classifiers                                         |
|                                                                                          | Decision Tree          | 70-80%              | Lower performance                                                  |
|                                                                                          | Support Vector Machine | 80-88%              | Performs well but less flexible                                    |
| 4. Orina, Rimiru & Mwangi (2023), A Comparative Study of                                 | Random Forest          | 85-90%              | Strong performance                                                 |
|                                                                                          | Support Vector Machine | 80-85%              | Good but less stable                                               |

Summary of research papers on bank client churn predictions.

| Model               | Test and Score                      |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Logistic Regression | Recall - 80.7%<br>Precision - 77.6% |
| Random Forest       | Recall - 84.7%<br>Precision - 83.5% |
| AdaBoost            | Recall - 79.3%<br>Precision - 79.4% |

Evaluation metrics for the top 3 suggested models.

The dataset was analysed in **Orange** using selected input features and a Random Forest classifier, evaluated with 10-fold cross-validation. The results show that machine learning can effectively predict customer churn and support proactive retention efforts.

Confusion Matrix for Random Forest from Orange

|        |                  | Predicted |                  | Σ    | Model         | AUC   | CA    | F1    | Prec  | Recall | MCC   |
|--------|------------------|-----------|------------------|------|---------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|--------|-------|
|        |                  | left      | still a customer |      |               |       |       |       |       |        |       |
| Actual | left             | 449       | 585              | 1034 | Random Forest | 0.818 | 0.847 | 0.832 | 0.835 | 0.847  | 0.475 |
|        | still a customer | 180       | 3786             | 3966 |               |       |       |       |       |        |       |
|        |                  | Σ         | 629              | 4371 | 5000          |       |       |       |       |        |       |

## Appendix & Acknowledgement

Additional details on data preparation, exploratory data analysis, and machine learning research supporting the results shown in this poster are available in the accompanying Excel workbook prepared for this project.

## References

[1] J. Adejo, “Using Machine Learning to Predict Customer Churn | Towards Data Science,” *Towards Data Science*, Feb. 14, 2021. <https://towardsdatascience.com/using-machine-learning-to-predict-customer-churn-cd499cb230db/>

[2] “Causes of customer churn | Stripe,” *Stripe.com*, 2024. <https://stripe.com/ae/resources/more/what-causes-churn-and-how-businesses-can-minimize-it>

[3] S. Charandabi, “Prediction of Customer Churn in Banking Industry.” Available: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2301.13099>

[4] SCISPACE, “SciSpace,” *scispace.com*, 2025. <https://scispace.com/>